Where You Are: Dad's Preferences, the Third Part of Step Two

The nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with yours marked, and what comes after it.

Asking Dad how he likes his days can seem like a project all its own. It has a place. It's the third part of the second of nine steps, and there's no clock on any of them.

This page shows the whole road, where you are on it, and what comes next, whenever your family gets there.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Care Starting Profile

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile

You are here. You're on the third part of this step, Lifestyle & Preferences: Dad's routines and preferences, asked of him and written down in his words. The family's part is done when there is a current page, it's clear where each note came from, and you know how you'll update it and share it appropriately.

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Preliminary Care Options Research and Decision Plan

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Planning File and Future Review Templates

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition-Readiness File and Future Handoff Template

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team, Communication, and Meeting-Readiness Kit

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Monitoring, Advocacy, and Review-Readiness Kit

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Starter Family Care Playbook and Future Support Plan

What this step produces

A dated page about Dad's ordinary day: how he likes to be addressed, his mornings and evenings, his meals, the people and pastimes that matter to him, and how he likes to be spoken with, with his likes kept apart from any allergy or doctor's instruction. It is a family's notes, organized. It isn't a care plan, and nothing on it is an instruction.

It's Dad's page before it's anyone else's. The federal Administration for Community Living describes person-centered planning as a process directed by the person who receives the support, one that includes the family members, friends and others that person wishes to include. [2]

Changing it is part of the design. The Conversation Project's workbook says people's preferences often change as their health changes or as time goes by, and suggests coming back to see whether the answers have changed. [1]

What happens next

This topic closes step two, Assess. With the two parts before it, health and function, and safety and support, it makes up the Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile. The step after it is called Define Needs, and it looks at needs and risks, care requirements, and priorities and recommendations.

In the Plan Ahead track there is no date on any of this. Your family takes the next step when it's ready to.

Who is involved, by role

- Dad: his own account of his days, his corrections, and his say over who reads the page.
- You and your family: asking, listening, writing down his words, and checking back with him.
- His doctor or pharmacist: any allergy, and anything a clinician has told him to eat or avoid. Which is which is theirs to say.
- Your care consultant: goes over Dad's routines and food preferences with the family, keeps preferences apart from restrictions, allergies and prescribed instructions, and talks through the activities he enjoys and any help he needs to take part in them.

What this page doesn't promise

How long any step takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. It also doesn't say Dad will ever need the later steps. Families move through them at different speeds, and in the Plan Ahead track nothing here has a date on it.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits, what it produces and what comes next. The care interview is how you finish it: it walks you through Dad's situation area by area, his preferences included, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The remark that preferences change over time is from The Conversation Project's workbook, and the description of person-centered planning is the Administration for Community Living's.

1. The Conversation Project (Institute for Healthcare Improvement) and Ariadne Labs, What Matters to Me: A Workbook for Better Health Care
2. Administration for Community Living, Person-Centered Planning